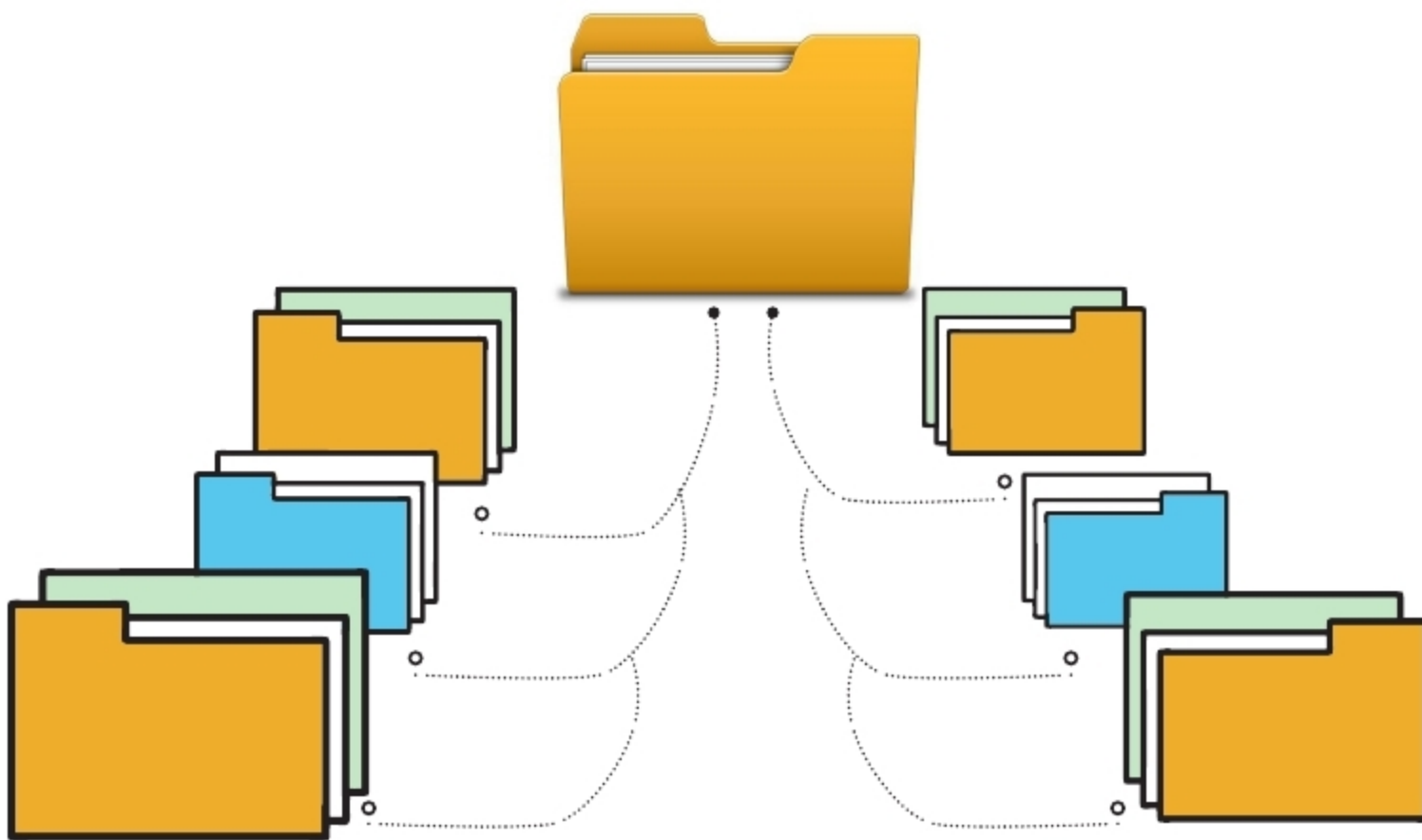


Disk and File Management Tools that Make Life Simpler

If spare disk space could be sold, everyone would become rich. The gigabytes of free space in an average computer enables users to store more and more data. But without powerful and user-friendly software utilities, any storage medium is just a brick. Let's list out some free file system tools that literally make life simpler for anyone who's got something to store. These range from browsers to monitoring, backup and recovery tools.



Before we begin, please note that this article is not a definitive how-to for free file system tools. After you decide to go with one, make sure to read all the necessary documentation and do some test runs since fiddling with disk utilities can be risky.

File managers

First things first — browsing must be the first activity that a novice user performs on disks, as the setting up of the computer is left to experts. The popular way to do this is, of course, by using the so-called file managers, which offer

multiple functionalities such as listing, creation, copying, moving, search, etc. The other way is to use dedicated command-line tools, manually.

An average user is familiar with the following navigational file managers:

- **Nautilus and its forks** — Nautilus (a.k.a. GNOME files) is the default file manager of the GNOME desktop. Simple and straightforward, it offers easy navigation with breadcrumbs and tabs, works with network places, and even offers full-text search. However, the interface modernisation following the inception of GNOME3 has drawn considerable criticism, making its forks more popular, like Caja (pronounced kah-hah) and Nemo.
- **Thunar** — The default one in Xfce, a good alternative if you don't like the new Nautilus.
- **Konqueror** — This KDE component tries to be a file manager, Web browser and file viewer, all at the same time, now focusing on the Web part more. Although it's not too user friendly as a file manager, the search feature is useful.
- **Dolphin** — This is the default KDE file manager.